Read This Before Running the Backend

JWT local setup is required — skipping this causes 500 errors on every endpoint

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Why this matters

The backend signs and validates JWT tokens using **Jwt:Key** and **Jwt:Issuer** from configuration (see `Program.cs` and `Services/CryptService.cs`). These values are **not** committed to `appsettings.json` — each developer sets them locally with `dotnet user-secrets`.

If they are not set, `Jwt:Key` is `null`, and `Encoding.UTF8.GetBytes(...)` throws — every endpoint, including `/games`, returns **500**.

Important: `Jwt:Key` must be at least 32 characters long. A shorter key fails with `IDX10720` when generating a token.

Setup (Windows / macOS / Linux)

1. Open the terminal.
2. Navigate to the backend project directory:

```
cd PSI-Arcade/SportMatch.API
```

3. Initialize user secrets for the project (safe to run even if already initialized):

```
dotnet user-secrets init
```

4. Set the JWT key (32+ characters):

```
dotnet user-secrets set "Jwt:Key" "your-local-development-secret-key-32chars+"
```

5. Set the JWT issuer:

```
dotnet user-secrets set "Jwt:Issuer" "SportMatch.API"
```

6. Verify the values were saved:

```
dotnet user-secrets list
```

Note: the project already has a `UserSecretsId` set in `SportMatch.API.csproj`, so `dotnet user-secrets init` will just report it is already initialized — it is included above as a no-op safety step in case that ever changes.